

UNIT - 01 UNDERSTANDING ONESELF AS AN INDIVIDUAL

Personality (व्यक्तित्व)

Personality refers to traits such as physical build, complexion/appearance, style of dressing, manner of conversation, and actions or behavior. The word personality is derived from the English word "Personality," which originates from the Latin word "Persona," meaning a mask.

In psychology, personality is a dynamic blend of both external and internal elements that changes continuously under environmental influences. Personality is an individual's way of adapting to their environment.

According to Valentine: "Personality is the sum total of innate and acquired tendencies."

According to Guilford: "Personality is an integrated pattern of traits."

The Big Five Traits of Personality:

1. Openness (खुलापन)
2. Conscientiousness (चैतन्यता)
3. Extraversion (बहिर्मुखता)
4. Agreeableness (सहामतिपन्यता)
5. Neuroticism (स्नायुविकृति)

Development of Personality:

Personality development is a continuous process. That is, it begins from conception and continues throughout life.

The stages of personality development are as follows:

1. Prenatal Stage (गर्भकालीन अवस्था)
2. Infancy (शैशवावस्था)
3. Childhood (बाल्यावस्था)
4. Adolescence (किशोरावस्था)
5. Adulthood (प्रौढ़ावस्था)

Curiosity to Understand One's Own Personality

For any individual to develop an understanding of their own personality, it is essential to ask themselves the question, "Who am I?". If a person has knowledge of their individual capabilities, it develops the self-confidence required to face life's difficulties, making them calm and resilient even in the toughest situations of life.

Who am I?: When an individual shows curiosity to understand their personality by asking who they are, there can be multiple answers. An individual can be a father, a son, or a student. A person continuously constructs a new identity regarding their personality.

Self vs. Ego: 'Self' refers to oneself. A person's 'self' is their consciousness regarding their own personality. Self refers to our behavior in daily life. Self is a person's belief and understanding about themselves. 'Ego' refers to pride or arrogance. Associating the concept of "I" with any person, object, or idea is ego, such as "I am like this, I am like that, I can do this."

Differences Between Self and Ego:

Self (स्वयं)	Ego (अहं / अहम्)
1) Self creates self-confidence in an individual.	1) Ego creates a narrow mindset in an individual.
2) Self is associated with positive emotions.	2) Ego is associated with negative emotions.
3) Self makes an individual cultured/refined.	3) Ego makes an individual short-tempered/angry.
4) In the context of social interaction, what an individual thinks about themselves is called the ego/self.	4) Ego is that set of reactions which includes perception, thinking, and memory. It functions as a reaction system for internal synthesis.

Identity (अस्मिता)

Identity means an individual's character—how a person behaves, what their virtues are, what their flaws are, and what their thoughts are. All these aspects together construct an identity. Every individual wants to live a safe and respectable life within their society and community, where the prominence lies in the individual's behavior, lifestyle, and mindset. If a person has a negative mindset and exhibits negative behavior toward the society or community, it directly poses a threat to that individual's identity, making them feel insecure and text-reproached.

Identity is constructed in the following ways:

1. Internal Identity (आन्तरिक अस्मिता)
2. External Identity (बाह्य अस्मिता)

1) Internal Identity: How an individual behaves, how they think, and what their views are depend entirely upon themselves. A person's identity develops through this internal thinking pattern.

2) External Identity: What kind of society a person prefers to live in, what their ideals are, how they think, where they place their faith, and what their opinions are depend entirely upon them, and their life is continuously influenced by this. Therefore, it plays an important role in building that individual's identity.

Necessity and Importance of Identity:

1. Identity is a concept through which an individual establishes their own recognition.
2. Through this, an individual identifies other people associated with their life.
3. We can comprehend what kind of person someone is only through their identity.

4. Identity plays an important role in categorizing what kind of people exist in our society, who belongs to which caste, which class, or which gender.
5. The socio-cultural background of any individual is recognized solely through their identity.

Writing a 'Self-Portrait'

A 'Self-Portrait' is a piece of writing in which an individual narrates or writes about themselves and incidents occurring in society to others. Writing about oneself is not easy because no person can fully capture their life experiences, talents, and skills in just one or two paragraphs. Every individual's self-portrait reflects their entire personality, through which the reader gains insights into various dimensions of their life. Through this, we can understand anyone's character.

We can write a self-portrait in the following manner:

1. Introducing oneself, i.e., "Who am I?"
2. Expressing one's thoughts and beliefs.
3. Stating one's virtues and flaws.
4. Sharing one's fields of interest.
5. Concluding based on the above points whether you are a positive or negative person, which forms the conclusion.

Understanding Self-Expression

Self-expression means an individual presenting their thoughts before others. Through self-expression, a person demonstrates their thoughts across various fields. Expression should be spontaneous, natural, and meaningful so that a valid conclusion can be drawn. Therefore, for meaningful self-expression, an individual must possess a clear understanding of self-expression.

Self-Respect (स्वाभिमान)

Self-respect is composed of two words: 'Sva' (Self) and 'Abhiman' (Pride). 'Sva' means oneself, and 'Abhiman' means pride or dignity; thus, self-respect means taking pride in oneself. Feeling proud of one's language, religion, work, and nation is self-respect. A person who possesses self-respect has a higher sense of self-worth in their personality. Every individual should feel proud of themselves. A person devoid of self-respect is like an animal. Self-respect is also called self-esteem. Self-respect implies that an individual must stand firmly on their own character and remain ever-ready to protect their duties and values.

Differences Between Self-Respect and Arrogance:

Self-Respect (स्वाभिमान)	Arrogance / Pride (अभिमान)
1) Self-respect leads to an individual's progress and growth.	1) Arrogance leads to an individual's downfall.

Self-Respect (स्वाभिमान)	Arrogance / Pride (अभिमान)
2) A person with self-respect possesses humility and modesty.	2) A person with arrogance possesses pride and conceit.
3) Self-respect is positive.	3) Arrogance is negative.
4) A self-respecting person does not waver from their path, nor are they afraid of facing difficulties.	4) An arrogant person always harbors a sense of underlying fear.
5) Self-respect sustains and builds an individual.	5) Arrogance destroys and finishes an individual.
6) Self-respect means, "I can do it too."	6) Arrogance means, "Only I can do it."

Types of Self-Esteem / Self-Respect:

1. **High Self-Esteem:** Individuals with high self-esteem have a high level of satisfaction. They are fully aware of their strengths, accept their flaws, and feel confident about overcoming them. They maintain a positive outlook toward their traits and capacities.
2. **Low Self-Esteem:** Children with low self-esteem have a low level of satisfaction. They rarely acknowledge their flaws, have little desire to rectify them, seldom showcase their capacities or skills, and harbor a negative mindset about themselves.
3. **Competence-Based Self-Esteem:** Individuals with competence-based self-esteem leave their respect to the judgment of others. They are always eager to fulfill the thoughts and feelings of others and depend heavily on social and religious ideals. These individuals are capable, but not in areas independent of others' approval.
4. **Worth-Based Self-Esteem:** In this type, the greater an individual's capabilities and internal worth, the higher their self-esteem. Their self-esteem is closely tied to their success, fluctuating with success and failure. Individuals with this type of self-esteem are highly hardworking, motivating, and skilled in specific tasks.

Self-Confidence (आत्मविश्वास)

Self-confidence means believing in oneself. Self-confidence is a mental and spiritual power. Individuals who possess high self-confidence achieve success across all their tasks and fields. A self-confident person protects themselves easily and effortlessly, and such individuals do not worry excessively about their future. Those who lack self-confidence always live in fear and doubt, failing to find success in their actions.

Self-confidence provides an individual with a unique inner strength that allows them to accomplish even the most difficult tasks easily. Self-confidence is highly required to achieve success in life. Without self-confidence, a person fails to attain their goals and cannot face challenges and problems. Therefore, to succeed in life, it is absolutely essential for an individual to have faith in themselves.

Characteristics of Self-Confidence:

1. An individual with self-confidence is highly skilled at executing tasks efficiently.
2. Self-confidence makes a person fearless; they do not feel afraid under any circumstance.
3. Such individuals are always at the forefront of learning something new every single day.
4. Self-confidence generates positive emotions and outlook within an individual.
5. A self-confident person thinks about others as well, wishing that their actions benefit everyone.

Ways to Enhance Self-Confidence:

1. Self-confidence comes from within an individual; therefore, to execute any task, we must have faith in ourselves.
2. To boost self-confidence, an individual must evaluate themselves and first understand their inner capacities.
3. To enhance self-confidence, a person should surround themselves with good people.
4. One should always maintain positive thinking.
5. One should harbor good and noble thoughts.

Self-Motivation (आत्म अभिप्रेरणा)

Motivation means that which drives or inspires an individual to perform a task. Motivation cannot be seen directly; it can only be inferred by observing an individual's behavior. When we require something, a desire is triggered within us. Motivation makes our goals firm and absolute. Motivation holds immense importance in every individual's life, helping them achieve comprehensive personality development and success. Without motivation, generating interest and momentum in an individual is impossible. Thus, motivation is that inner driving force that inspires a person to act in a specific way.

According to Good: "Motivation is the process of arousing, sustaining, and regulating activity."

According to Drever: "Motivation is an affective-dynamic factor which determines the direction of an individual's behavior toward a set goal, whether consciously or unconsciously."

Self-motivation means that an individual depends on their own inner thinking. When a person develops positive thinking, self-motivation can also be cultivated. External motivation is often required to trigger internal self-motivation.

Nature of Motivation:

1. Motivation keeps an individual active until their ultimate objective or goal is successfully achieved.
2. Motivation always originates from some underlying need.
3. It is an internal force that arises within a person to achieve a specific purpose.
4. Motivation is simultaneously a process and a result.
5. Motivation is a psycho-behavioral process.

There are two types of motivation:

1. Intrinsic / Internal (आन्तरिक)
2. Extrinsic / External (बाह्य)

Strong and Weak Sides of a Teacher (Male/Female)

The weak and strong aspects of a teacher are detailed below:

Strong Sides (मजबूत पक्ष):

1. A teacher must possess self-control, composure, and tolerance.
2. A teacher must practice secularism and impartiality.
3. They should be friendly and approachable to students.
4. Teachers should not restrict their focus solely to textbook content; they must engage students in co-curricular activities.
5. A teacher must be highly patient.
6. A teacher's instruction should be highly flexible so that students can comprehend concepts easily.
7. A teacher must pay close attention to where the students' actual interests lie inside the classroom.
8. A teacher must closely monitor how much the students are understanding what is being taught.
9. A teacher should behave excellently with students, cultivating deep respect and prestige toward educators in the students' minds.
10. Teachers must possess total fairness and lack of bias.

Weak Sides (कमजोर पक्ष):

1. Lacking self-control, composure, and tolerance.
2. Lacking mastery or excellent command over the medium of language.
3. Teaching students rigidly according to their own preferences or strictly following textbooks.
4. Failing to bring flexibility into the lesson content.
5. Failing to teach the core content through active, activity-based methods or games.

6. Not being friendly or approachable with students.
7. Constantly scolding or reprimanding students over minor issues.
8. Students failing to understand what the teacher is trying to explain.
9. Practicing favoritism or bias among students.
10. Not maintaining good professional relationships with fellow teachers.

UNIT - 02 AWARENESS TOWARD ONE'S IDENTITY

Identity of Teachers (शिक्षकों की अस्मिता)

Teachers play a monumental role in building our society, because society is formed by those very children whose primary education is entrusted to a teacher. It is the teacher who, along with shaping a child into a good citizen, drives their optimal, all-round development. The holistic development of children happens solely through a teacher. Teachers also provide professional or vocational education to children so they can utilize it in their daily life. It is an absolute responsibility of a teacher to provide correct education, inspiration, tolerance, positive behavioral modification, and accurate guidance to their children. Along with brightening their future, they must shape them into better human beings. A teacher holds an elevated and respectable position in the world and society.

In ancient times, a teacher was not viewed merely as an instructor; rather, they were revered as a beacon of knowledge, the light of life, and equivalent to God. At present, a teacher is often downplayed merely as a government employee whose task is to instruct. Modern teachers are highly organized, technologically skilled, and possess attractive personalities. Modern times have given rise to the urgent need for a political and social evaluation of teachers.

Concept and Traits of an Ideal Teacher:

1. An ideal teacher functions as a true friend.
2. They possess excellent health, patience, tolerance, and highly refined behavior.
3. They are punctual, full of self-confidence, and backed by a firm willpower.
4. They possess deep knowledge of their subject matter, love, and empathy.
5. A teacher must be approachable, democratic, collaborative, and benevolent.
6. They must have an excellent command over language.
7. They should be a skilled thinker with a deep sense of culture and civilization.
8. They must be thoroughly acquainted with child nature and educational psychology.

Qualities of an Ideal Teacher According to the National Curriculum Framework (NCF 2005):

1. A teacher must deeply understand their core responsibility toward society.
2. Make practical hands-on work the primary medium of instruction to provide experiential learning both inside and outside the classroom.
3. Teachers must implement active learning-by-doing instructional methods for students.
4. They must maintain excellent, supportive behavior toward students.
5. They must be capable of facing multi-faceted challenges arising from universalization, privatization, cultural, geographical, social, and political contexts, and remain a continuous lifelong learner.
6. Textbook knowledge must be seamlessly linked to the daily real life of the students.

Identifying One's Own Role as a Teacher

1. To identify their own role, a teacher must first understand and evaluate themselves thoroughly.
2. A teacher must know both their positive strengths and negative weaknesses to deliver excellent knowledge to students.
3. A teacher primarily provides education to foster development across all dimensions of a student's personality.
4. A teacher's role is critically instrumental in the holistic, all-round development of students.
5. They must mold the classroom environment to match educational requirements and provide a correct direction to students.
6. It is the absolute duty of a teacher to introduce students to morality and social values, molding them to fit beautifully into society.

Challenges Faced by a Teacher

The primary challenges before a teacher include:

1. Monitoring the classroom environment continuously—checking whether children are sitting quietly or creating a noisy disturbance.
2. Tracking whether children are arriving at school on time and checking whether they are attending the morning assembly regularly.
3. Ensuring whether the material being taught in class is fully comprehensible to the children and checking whether they are taking an active interest in it.
4. Assessing whether students are accurately understanding the language mechanics of textbooks.
5. Managing a high student-to-teacher ratio; if the number of students in a class is excessively large, the teacher will fail to pay individual attention to every student.
6. Educating children regarding the vital importance of preserving and protecting the school building and institutional resources.
7. Supervising and monitoring children carefully on the sports field or playground.
8. Inspiring and motivating students to live and learn together cooperatively within a highly diverse classroom.

UNIT - 03 UNDERSTANDING ONE'S WORK AND LIFE

OBJECTIVES

Daily Reflective Diary (दैनिक रिफ्लेक्टिव डायरी)

Through a daily reflective diary, a multitude of positive qualities can be actively cultivated in students, optimizing their work and behavior. On the other hand, it makes their functional behavior highly useful from a professional, social, and political perspective. A daily reflective diary is also popularly known as a contemplative or thinking diary.

In this diary, a teacher writes down the pleasant and unpleasant day-to-day incidents associated with the school. The main benefit of this practice is that it helps an individual organize and execute their tasks sequentially. It allows a person to analyze and evaluate themselves and their work, paving the way to rectify mistakes and improve their positive and negative sides. A complete verification of one's positive and negative aspects is conducted here. Therefore, a daily reflective diary is intrinsically connected to self-evaluation and self-rectification.

Goals of a Reflective Diary:

The primary goal of a reflective diary is to guide oneself in the correct direction. It involves documenting one's day-to-day incidents, work, and behavior, thereby providing an organic opportunity for deep self-analysis and self-evaluation. It forces an individual to become aware of their inner shortcomings and provides a constructive platform on how to systematically improve those flaws.

Uses of a Reflective Diary:

A diary acts as a person's truest friend. We write it ourselves daily. When we are unable to express our innermost thoughts openly before others, we write them down in our diary. Keeping a diary is a deeply significant task in itself, through which we can smoothly comprehend ourselves with total clarity.

Characteristics of a Reflective Diary:

1. In a daily reflective diary, real incidents, factual data, personal actions, and behavioral patterns are systematically recorded.
2. A daily reflective diary is widely accepted as a highly creative process, because after analyzing and synthesizing their internal thoughts, an individual formulates fresh practical rules, values, and principles for life.
3. When a person writes a diary, they engage in diverse forms of constructive logical reasoning and self-dialogue.
4. There is absolutely no external pressure on an individual while writing a diary; a person writes it solely for their own internal spiritual peace and mental serenity.
5. In this practice, an individual evaluates their actions and executes self-assessment objectively.

How to Maintain/Create a Reflective Diary:

1. First and foremost, write down the exact date, day, and page number at the top of the diary page.
2. Following this, mention the specific time and subject/topic clearly.

3. Subsequently, incorporate core points related to your positive strengths and negative weaknesses, explicitly penning down your personal thoughts and reflections on them.

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